Rainbow – the chakra system

Brown has **no stripe of its own** in the rainbow. Yet without it you can hardly imagine a landscape, trunks, soil, branches, seeds and stones. In the current seven-colour chakra map some modern approaches place it next to red, with the **root chakra** and the themes of **grounding** and home base.

The whole rainbow as a map of questions

Red · root
Support, safety, presence. Ask yourself. What can I lean on?

Orange · sacral
Experiencing, pleasure, sensuality. Ask yourself. What does me good?

Yellow · solar plexus
Self-worth, will, decision-making. Ask yourself. What do I want to choose for myself?

Green · heart
Closeness, kindness, relationships. Ask yourself. Where can I be open and still stay with myself?

Blue · throat
Voice, expression, communication. Ask yourself. What do I need to say?

Indigo · third eye
Inner vision, intuition, discernment. Ask yourself. What is beginning to dawn on me?

Violet · crown
Transcendence, meaning, connection. Ask yourself. What gives me a wider sense of meaning?

Brown · beside the root
Home base and nourishment. Ask yourself. What really supports me in everyday life?

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Muladhara, the root chakra

Chakras come from the Indian yogic and tantric tradition. The first chakra is called Muladhara. It sits at the base of the spine and, according to descriptions, has four petals. In classical texts red is linked with it. Brown is added to it only in some contemporary approaches, as an accompaniment to earth, physicality and grounding.

Its theme is **support**, safety and the feeling that you have your place in the world. It need not be anything grand. It is an ordinary table, regular meals, a safe home or a person in front of whom you do not have to perform. Roots are mostly unseen too, and yet a tree relies on them a great deal.

When the chakra is in balance. You have something to lean on and you do not have to be always ready to bolt. You can rest and yet are not afraid to move.

When the chakra is out of balance. Modern interpretations describe either insecurity and constant vigilance, or on the contrary too much clinging to certainties. These are not proofs of the state of a chakra, they are situations in which you can get to know yourself. **A habit that protects you does not have to prevent your next step.**

In today's approach brown is one of the companions of this chakra beside red. It serves you as a reminder and a support. It is not a treatment, it is an invitation to notice what does you good.

How to add brown when you lack a home base

- **Put it in food**
  A wooden table, a ceramic bowl, lunch without a phone. A meal should have its place and you are not the last item on the list.
- **Put it on**
  A brown jumper, coat or scarf in a natural material. Something that surrounds you comfortably.
- **Put it in your hand**
  A wooden pendant, a smooth pebble or a mug that is nice to hold.
- **Take it with you**
  A chestnut in your pocket, a leather cord on your wrist or a handful of nuts for the road.
- **Paint it**
  Wide areas with a spatula or brush. Your hands are busy with something that has resistance, a beginning and an end.
- **Take it outside**
  Bark, cones, branches, dry leaves and soil. Count how many shades of brown you find.

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When certainty begins to bind

Some modern interpretations regard too much clinging to certainties as a sign of imbalance of the root chakra. For your own reflection you can use the question whether your habits protect you or no longer let you take a step. **You do not need more brown.** You need to invite other colours.

- **Add orange**
  The theme of pleasure and sensuality. Warmth that gets you moving.
- **Add yellow**
  The theme of your own choice. Something you chose today.
- **Add green**
  An image of growth. A plant, a walk, fresh air.
- **Add light blue**
  A sense of space, if you find it in it. An open window.

This is inspiration from tradition, not treatment. Try gently and notice how you actually feel afterwards.

Picture it with an example

After a period of change you suddenly enjoy something familiar, tangible and simple. A brown jumper, wood or ceramics. **You do not have to turn it into a message from the subconscious.** Try to notice what exactly attracts you. The shade, the material, a memory, or comfort?

Next to brown other colours can feel warm. Green brings it to life, cream brightens it and blue cools it. **These are possibilities for personal reading**, not effects prescribed by a colour combination.

How to use this map

It is a way to sort out the themes you are living through. Do you add brown because you lack firm ground, or put it aside because being settled has slightly stiffened for you? **You choose the meaning.** An added colour does not diagnose your state.

Brown has no place in the classical seven-colour map, not even an eighth.

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